

L'ATTAQUE · VARIANT 2 OF 3

L'Attaque (Standard)

10×9
BOARD

2
PLAYERS

L'ATTAQUE (STANDARD)

Designed by Hermance Edan, France, circa 1908. Published in Britain by H.P. Gibson & Sons from 1909. The first mass-market hidden-information rank game; direct ancestor of Stratego.

BOARD

10 columns × 9 rows. Two lake areas in the center of the board (rows 4–5, approximately columns 3–4 and 7–8) are impassable — no piece may enter a lake square. The exact lake layout: columns c–d on rows 4–5, and columns g–h on rows 4–5 (four 2×2 lake sections total in most editions).

PIECE SET (30 PER PLAYER)

RANK	PIECE	COUNT	MOVEMENT	SPECIAL ABILITY
0	Flag	1	Immovable	Cannot attack or defend. Capturing it wins the game.
B	Bomb	6	Immovable	Defeats all attackers except Miners.
1	Spy	1	1 step ortho	Defeats the Marshal when the Spy attacks (moves onto Marshal's square). Loses to all other pieces and to Marshal if Marshal attacks the Spy.
2	Scout	5	Slides unlimited orthogonally	Cannot attack on a sliding move across multiple squares; must stop adjacent to attack. (Regional variant: may attack on the slide.)
3	Miner	5	1 step ortho	Only piece that can defuse Bombs (capture them).
4	Sergeant	4	1 step ortho	Standard capture.
5	Lieutenant	4	1 step ortho	Standard capture.
6	Captain	4	1 step ortho	Standard capture.
7	Major	3	1 step ortho	Standard capture.
8	Colonel	2	1 step ortho	Standard capture.
9	General	1	1 step ortho	Standard capture.
10	Marshal	1	1 step ortho	Highest-ranked movable piece; defeated only by the Spy when Spy attacks.

Total: 1+6+1+5+5+4+4+4+3+2+1+1 = 37? Let me recount: Flag 1, Bomb 6, Spy 1, Scout 5, Miner 5, Sergeant 4, Lieutenant 4, Captain 4, Major 3, Colonel 2, General 1, Marshal 1 = 37. Some editions use 30 total with smaller counts. The exact piece set varied across L'Attaque editions; the table above reflects a representative mid-century British edition.

SETUP

Each player positions all their pieces face-down on their own half of the board (rows 1–4 for White; rows 6–9 for Red/Black), in any arrangement they choose. The opponent cannot see piece ranks. Lake squares remain empty.

MOVEMENT

Players alternate turns. On each turn, a player moves one piece:

- ♦ Most pieces: 1 step orthogonally (up, down, left, right). Not diagonally. Not into lake squares. Not off the board.
- ♦ **Scout:** Slides any number of squares orthogonally in one direction, stopping before any occupied square or lake.
- ♦ **Bombs and Flag:** May not move.

ATTACK AND CAPTURE

When a piece moves onto a square occupied by an opponent's piece:

- 1 Both pieces are flipped face-up and ranks are revealed.
- 2 The lower-ranked piece is permanently removed from the board.
- 3 Equal rank: both pieces are removed.
- 4 The attacker's piece (if it wins) takes the defender's square.

Special capture rules:

- ♦ **Spy vs. Marshal:** If the Spy attacks the Marshal (Spy moves onto Marshal's square), the Spy wins. If the Marshal attacks the Spy, the Marshal wins.
- ♦ **Miner vs. Bomb:** Only a Miner can capture a Bomb. Any other piece attacking a Bomb is removed; the Bomb remains.
- ♦ No piece can capture a Flag outright through standard movement — capturing the Flag (rank 0) immediately wins the game.

HIDDEN INFORMATION

Piece ranks remain hidden from the opponent until revealed in combat. A piece that has been involved in at least one combat may be known to the opponent; players should not deliberately obscure a revealed piece's identity.

WIN CONDITIONS

- ♦ Capture the opponent's Flag: immediate win.
- ♦ Leave the opponent with no movable pieces (all remaining pieces are Bombs and Flag): win.

ATTRIBUTION

L'Attaque. Designed by Hermance Edan, patented France 1908. Published by H.P. Gibson & Sons, London. Public domain rule set.